READER ASSIGNMENT: LET'S TALK ABOUT MYTHS

Part 1: Research

Step 1:

Find 3 different myths:

- It needs a small summary of each myth
- Explain what times are in it
- And what aspects am I interested to use

Seven Deadly sins in the Christian bible and western traditions:

The Seven deadly sins, although it is never shown directly in the bible, Bad behavior and actions are being put under one of the seven sins in its category. The list of sins most people know are: pride, greed, lust, envy, gluttony, wrath and sloth. The first one pride, is the worst one out of them all by far, and is shown as the very essence of evil.

The seven deadly sins used to be different and had more/different sins. In Greek Mythology the monk Evarius Ponticus listed the eight evil thoughs. Each is put into a different category and could by listed as three types. Those types are: appetite, irascibility*, corruption

* irascibility: The quality to get easily angered or to become angry quickly. Or as I like to call it, being able to get rage bated easily.

(Yes, I did go a bit overboard with the next extra part, I was to interested in the subject.)

All the (part)sins summarized.

Those eight are:

1. Gluttony

2. Lust, fornication, prostitution
3. Avarice, greed
4. Pride, hubris (could be shown as self-overestimation, arrogance, grandiosity)
5. Sorrow, despair, despondency, sadness (to others fortune), envy
6. Wrath
7. Boasting, vainglory
8. Sloth

Gluttony: is a desire for an amount of food you do not need. It also represents lack of control in relation with food that harms your body.

Lust: having an intense desire, mostly of sexual nature. It destroys moral code and shows selfishness.

Fornication: two persons having sexual activity while not being married to eachother

Prostitution: Making money by using your body in a sexual meaning.

Avarice: Having a high desire for wealth and material items.

Greed: Much like Avarice, you have a high desire for wealth and material items. But also have a desire for power. The big difference between the two are that while Avarice and Greed both have immense desires, greed does not care about the expense of others.

Pride: loving and believing into yourself to much that you think you have superiority over others. It is by far the worst sin of them all. You can't acknowledge anyone, even gods. You look down on others so much that you get blinded by your believe in yourself.

Hubris: Hubris is a specific part of Pride. Your pride makes you so arrogant that you refuse to believe in any power higher then you.

Sorrow: hating yourself so much by others fortune that you get a high desire to get it yourself through moral improvement. This sin really is two sides of a coin, or that reason I think it might be the best to end up with out of all the (part)sins.

Despair: rejecting the mercy of GOD to save and forgive you.

Despondency: You willingly refuse to fight against any sins, that ends you up with despair.

Sadness (to others fortune): a part of envy and represents sorrow pretty well with it.

Envy: to love something from someone else so much that you grow an intense desire to have what they have. I think envy shows the best what it means when you love something to much. Because even though it doesn't directly show, it does kind off represent what it means to being able to let go.

Wrath: Wrath is the easiest to understand out of them all. It really just means uncontrolled anger and the will of vengeance and revenge.

Boasting: Not being able to give glory to GOD, but only in yourselves achievements.

Vainglory: Faking pride because of a desire for recognition and praise of others.

Sloth: Really simply said, not being able to give effort or/and being lazy.

Lucifer in the Christian bible

Lucifer is believed to be the fallen angel out of heaven. In Christian theology itself he is shown to be the Devil.He is also associated with the sin pride. It is believed that Lucifer has attempted to take over the throne of GOD, for that, he got banished to Hell.

His name before he was called the devil was “Morning star”. If you translate Lucifer the meaning has something to do with “light” and “the bringer of light”. Because of the sin a brought upon GOD, he was dethroned that beautiful name.

Asmodeus

It is a less known myth about the man Asmodeus. He is featured in stories across religion and has different meanings around those.

In Greek Mythology Asmodeus meant the king of demons. It was written in the legends of Solomon* and the constructing of Solomon’s Temple*

* **Solomon**, also called **Jedidiah**,[b] was the fourth monarch of the kingdom of Israel according to the Hebrew Bible.

* **Solomon's Temple**, also known as the **First Temple, A biblical Temple in Jerusalem**

Asmodeus Represents the deadly sin of Lust and is one of the seven kings of Hell. Demonology explains that he is a demonic figure that twist the sexual feelings of others

Aspects I would like to use myself are a broader myth that isn’t about one man. But it could be someone who represents a certain type of thing.

Step 2

I chose the sin “Pride” from the seven deadly sins as the thing I want to present.

Answer a few questions

Where does the concept of Pride originate from?

It primarily comes from the Christian Bible old testaments. And then the warning of Lucifers fall due to his arrogance. Also the story of Adam and Eve is the first shown thing about pride in the bible, that is because Adam wanted to be as strong as god.

Who are the main-characters?

In history Lucifer represents pride, in the modern days we got characters as: Homelander from The Boys and Escanor from The Seven Deadly Sins.

What motivates them?

I don’t think it even is motivating. They believe so much in themselves that they already believe they are the best. There is no motivation needed

What is the deeper theme of the myth?

Pride, it shows you how to be the best of yourself, you start believing in your actions. That is self believe. Pride is much alike but there is no room for grow. You already think you are the best, better then gods and others. It blinds you from mistakes and is just the worst overall. Pride hides itself among the other sins. For example, if I killed someone out of revenge, it would be the sin of Wrath. But if I believe I did nothing wrong and it is a good thing what I did, that would then be Pride, hiding itself as Wrath.

What is the myth used for?

`The sin of Pride shows us that we aren’t the actual best of the best around. It shows us that we are not as strong as the Gods. By learning what it means you learn that what you think is right could also be wrong, it learns you to be open for change. It is like a life lesson.

It could be kind off blurry what I am trying to tell here, because Pride can’t be explained in a few sentences. It goes a lot deeper then that.

Step 3

A modern adaptation of the myth.

Lucifer:

Lucifer as a character is the first one that had ever to represent Pride. It is the first modern adaptation if you think about it. Pride was only explained through ideas and words, until Lucifer. Yes, it might off be a very while ago. But it stills represents it perfectly though. It thought it was better than God itself; he was blinded by it share amount of confidence and believe in himself that he was banished. Through the banish he became as everyone knows now the devil.

There is a show that's based of Lucifer. It is called Lucifer with the main character Lucifer Morningstar. He is a bored Devil and wanted to just have fun on earth. From itself the show barely to do anything with pride. But the one who represents Pride, Lucifer, has a lot of shows and modern adaptations based off him.

Maybe the most obvious modern adaptation out of them all is Escanor from The Seven Deadly Sins. He has a very Prideful personality that changes in day and night.

Because of Escanor's pride, he actually isn't a bad person. He never holds hatred towards anyone, even the Demons showed during the show. He does pity them, he things he is the best of all and has no reason to hate anyone for there strength.

My attacks have no effect on you?

Who decided that?

Your darkness swallowed up my sun?

Who decided that?

I'll be the one who decides

These are the voice lines he is mainly known of. During a battle he was losing because the opponent had the upper hand in power. Even though that, he never believed that he was stronger than him. Yes, he did recognize his opponent strength, but because of his pride, he was never able to think that he was actually stronger than him.

In Re: Zero, a very clear shown of the sin of Pride hasn't been shown in the main story line, which is about the route of Envy (completely different subject). But in the What If stories, it explained what would've happened if he went to the route of Pride.

Before I explain the Pride If route, a thing you should know about is Subaru's Return By Death. Subaru can die, but he relives the same moment again in an earlier moment in time. For him he dies quite a lot. In the anime towards arc 4, he has died around 20 times.

The Pride If route mainly happens in arc 1 and 2.

In the Pride route he never askes Reinhart, a very strong swordsman for help. For that he was killed almost 100 times by Elsa, a very strong witch. It caused him to go insane and join the Cult of Witches. He became the archbishop of Pride and believed he was the strongest. In help of getting Emilia to the throne. He kills everyone else on the way, including his friends.

Because of he was never able to ask for help and show is weakness. He became blinded by it and stopped listening to anyone who thought different of him.

(later note: I am sorry, I might off went a bit overboard again with the amount of words, was again to interested)

Step 4

Presentation

Things I want to say during the presentation.

I want to spend around 1.5 minutes explaining the sin Pride.

The rest of the time I want to explain the modern adaptation and Lucifer.

Thing I have to say to explain a deep context about pride

- A little bit where it came from: The idea from the Greek Mythology and the explanation from the Christian Bible.
- What it means and the small difference about self-confidence and Pride
- Why Pride is by far the worst sin, the reasons why it is that terrible: It makes you believe wrong, it blinds you to your surroundings, you stop getting better because you believe you are the best.
- Confidence into delusion.
- Pride hides itself into the other sins

About Lucifer

- Explain that lucifer is the first adaptation to Pride.
- His downfall: Pride made him into the Devil

Modern adaptations, I am going to tell about multiple characters why Pride was a big role to them and maybe how they have overcome it.

I am planning to talk small explanations about multiple characters (More characters -> less deep dive into one)

- Tony stark (Iron Man 2):

He is dying of heart failure, but instead of reaching out to others. He drowns himself in reckless actions. His pride tells him that he can fix it on his own, he can save himself and everyone else. Which almost let him close to death and a lot of misery.

- Zuko from avatar the last airbender

He spends years hunting the avatar for his dad's approval, uncle Iroh tried to explain that it is wrong but Zuko's pride to his father and the fire nation let him be the worst of himself.

After admitting he was wrong to Uncle Iroh, it showed him that humanity isn't a bad thing and made him stronger than he was before.

- Walter White from Breaking Bad

During the show, Walter always wanted more, he wanted to be the best and made him blind which ultimately led to his downfall. This show perfectly shows us what it means when Pride hides itself under another sin, which was Greed in this case.

- Escanor from the Seven Deadly Sins

Escanor doesn't commit the sin of Pride; he is the sin of Pride. He always believes that he is the best and he pities all other people. Because of that personality he never truly hates anyone and cares about the weak, which are in his eyes, everyone in the world.

He never gives up and doesn't believe he can lose. That's why when his opponent says that his attacks don't do anything to him, he brings us his most famous line:

My attacks have no effect on you?

Who decided that?

Your darkness swallowed up my sun?

Who decided that?

I'll be the one who decides

- Subaru's what if story (If I need extra time, which I strongly believe I don't)

Just talk about the pride If, which I know decently well, also explain Subaru's actions and why he can be this way (Return by Death)

PART 2 - BRAINSTORMING AND CONCEPTING

Step 1

6 concept version about a personal myth

A highly skilled arcane magician saves the prince from an attack/crash.

The prince is far from home and asks the arcane magician to accommodate him back home.

The arcane magician agrees and along the journey they get to know each other well and become great friends

A blizzard traps the prince in a mountain pass, he lost his convoy during an attack of a mythical beast. A lone arcane magician finds him, frozen and almost dead.

She learns he is the prince of a fallen kingdom, she decides to escort him home through the wild road north.

Along the road, they learn a lot about each other. Their differences and the knowledge they both know.

After a crash in the desert, the prince wakes up to see a blue-cloaked mage taking care of him in the oasis nearby.

He begs to guide him home, but illusions makes him question everything.

During the journey, he learned a lot about himself and in the end, he figures out that the mage was pure his imagination.

A arcane magician rescues the prince from bandits, and starts healing his wounds without a word.

He insists he should accompany him back to his capital as for his payment, but he stays silent.

Their friendship blooms not during talking, but in gestures, trust.

Later he learns the reason why he can't talk.

An arcane magician saves the prince's ship from sinking with a colossal wave.

He convinces her to travel with him, promising gold and recognition back home.

But the closer they get home, more weird things to happen.

A wandering mage rescues the prince from a grewsome death.

She agrees to guide him home, after centuries of traveling the prince finally arrived home.

While he aged quite a lot. The mage hadn't changed a bit.

The prince starts the understand the double edge of a sword about immortality.

Step 2

- What themes would you like to use?

List of things I am going to include:

1. The trait of eternal youth
2. The prince of the fallen kingdom
3. Demi humans (I don't know the name of their race yet)
4. Magic
5. Relics
6. The meaning of it being a double edged sword.

- When is your myth taking place?

It doesn't have an exact time period. But it is about how the first king of the biggest nation, became the king from nothing.

- What would your myth like to tell?

That nothing great comes without a cost

About sacrifices

Step 3: the main characters

- Who are they?

We have 2 main characters.

1. The prince of the fallen kingdom.
2. An arcane magician who has the trait of eternal youth

- What is their drive?

1. The prince wants to take back the kingdom from the demons who took over the kingdom. His bloodline are the holders of the divine protection. An old ritualic way of life to keep the demons in their own realm. It is called "The Curtain". By not taking his job as the divine protector, he failed to keep the ritual in place and allowed a distortion to become place. During an eclipse, the demons are able to use their magic powers to their maximum, they broke through The Curtain and defeated the humans with ease. While the prince was able the barely escape. Almost everyone else was taking to be slaves.

2. The arcane magician, he lives isolated from the kingdom, barely outside of it, just across the big mountain range. He grew up in one of the forests of the kingdom, it is there where he learned his broad knowledge of relics, magic and fighting styles from a spirit of a dead royal guard. He learned that arcane magic is an abbreviation of other sort(s) of magic and about the 3 forbidden forms of (arcane) magic: "Necromancy, Blooding and Clockveil". Growing up he never was able to use proper magic but became a skilled fighter with his weapon of choose a staff. After locating the tomb of eternal youth, he acquired the Staff of Time. But he became 'cursed' with the trait of eternal youth. After enjoying it first, he figured out that having eternal youth was a curse. Since he didn't know what to do with his life, he decided to fix the problem of overflowing creatures at the mountain range up north. He stayed barely outside the kingdom, making sure no creatures went over the mountain range. (little backstory context)

   He had a dream, a dream of a peaceful death at an old age. Because of the knowledge he had learned, he never though he was able to get rid of his curse. But times had changed. The prince said that he acquired the potential in the magic from his divine

protection. To get rid of the curse for exchange of his magic power of time. They made. A deal together. The magician will help freeing the kingdom of the demons in exchange the prince will learn his divine protection probably and get rid of his curse.

* The Curtain is a thin, non-physical barrier the separates the 2 realms.

- What do they want?

1. The prince wants to free his kingdom back from the devils and for fill his task as the divine protector
2. The arcane magician wants to be freed of his curse of eternal youth and die a peaceful death of old age.

- How do they add to the plot of your myth?

Both the main characters are almost complete opposites of each other. But the one thing they both have in common is that they never needed someone else. The prince being a royal member with great powers with high potential and the magician being one of the strongest beings at the time, they both must learn to work together and trust each other. Since they need each other to want their wish to be for filled.

Part 4

Step 1

Check the bottom version, which feels more like a myth.

Prologue:

Once upon a time, before the kingdom of Azurae was thriving, the seers expanding on knowledge, swordsman training to become Royal Protectors and magicians casting new spells. A beautiful sight of the bright sights of the dark orange and light blue suns. But it wasn't always like this. There was a time where the kingdom had fallen into darkness.

* The Curtain is a thin, non-physical barrier the separates the realm of humans and demons.

*Arcane magic is an abbreviation of another magic arts.

*The 3 forbidden magic arts are: “Necromancy, Blooding and Clockveil”. About them are very little known. Only that each have an own Relic connected to it to activate the art.

The prince of Azurae, his name was Taro Von Astrea. The royal family of Von Astrea, holders of the magic of the Divine Protection. The magic art only runs through his bloodline and are the ritual keepers of The Curtain. Taro was the holder of the Divine Protection during his time of ruling. The unserious nature of Taro personality made him not learn the magic art to its fullest potential and by distortions started taking place in The Curtain.

Very suddenly, the beautiful suns of Astrea, stopped shining. The kingdom fell into darkness. Following that darkness, the demons showed up. It had seemed like the two realms had merged into one. The Curtain shattered because Taro failed to for fill his task as the Divine Protector. The entire kingdom fell into grasp of the demons and became the mortal servants.

Tora escaped from the grasp of the demons by sheer luck and ran up far north into the mountains of Rondo. The 14 mountains of Rondo are known for their harsh living conditions. It is a place where the temperature is always below -14 degree Celsius, A place overwhelmed by mythical creatures and blizzards that seem to get worse day to day. His unpleasant stay into the mountains made him pass out of the high amount of frost applied to him.

In his last conscious moments, something caught him by surprise thinking about it. In the sheer amount of time spent at the mountains of Rondo, he never saw anything mythical alive.

It was warm, he could feel the waves of heat coming of a fireplace nearby. He was wide awake, physically he felt great. He checked his scars he got during his time in the mountains, but nothing was there. He knew he felt dizzy, but he was sure he should have them. Looking around the campsite, to his left he saw a shallow river, with his royal attire. A combination of dark orange and light blue patterns on the highest quality white fabric robes. He felt a moment of grace seeing his familiar clothes so close in sight.

It was silent and dark until he heard a voice ask him: “Did you sleep well?” in a sarcastic tone. The man stood up and sat down next to him, offering him some provisions. “My name is Ryo, what about yours?” he said and with no time to answer he immediately asked. “Are you feeling any better now? You were freezing up there.”. Tora answered politely on Ryo, and they went on to get to know each other known better while Tora was trying to process what all just overcame him.

A few days had passed, and he finally understood that because of his sloth, his kingdom had fallen into the hands of demons. He wanted to change that and wanted to free the people of Azurae. But something else was on his mind. How did he get out of the mountains of Rondo,

without any injuries or scars? He noticed that he doesn't know much of Ryo, most of the conversations the past few days were about me, he was thinking that.

Ryo? Could you tell about yourself? And I would like to know how I am still alive.

Ryo went on a rant about himself. He explained that he used to live in the Kingdom of Azurae a millennium ago. He grew up in one of the big forests the kingdom has, where he trained and gained knowledge from a spirit from a death Royal Protector. He explained what exactly arcane magic is and the 3 forbidden magic arts. From the way he was speaking, it was clear that he hadn't spoken to someone in centuries. He said he never was able to use any of the magic arts to its proper form until he created his own. Arcane magic, he explained that it was a very different way of using magic and that it was based on the ice variant of water magic. It was a bit vague to understand.

The next part was about the tomb of eternal youth. He found the location by reading old testaments. He became the holder of the Staff of Time, the relic of Clockveil, and he is now able to slow, stop or rewind time by will. He explained that, that is how he got me better, by rewinding time before I got heavenly injured. But there was one major drawback, he was cursed with the trait of eternal youth.

Ryo decided to leave Azurae and live at the other side of the mountains of Ronto. With his power and knowledge, he has been protecting the kingdom for centuries. His dream was to die peacefully of old age. But he never believed he was able to get rid of his curse.

Taro: *Ryo, remember when I told you that I was the holder of the Divine Protection?*

Ryo: *Yes, I do remember.*

Taro: *Divine Protection has the potential to remove magic abilities on its fullest potential. If you accommodate and help me restoring The Curtain, I will learn to remove your eternal youth.*

Ryo: *That's a promise?*

Taro: *Yes, I promise!*

This is a more myth styled text variant

Prologue: The Shattered Suns

Once upon a time, before the Kingdom of Azurae flourished, seers who sought the deepest truths of existence, swordsmen who honed their blades until they shone like the edge of destiny itself, and magicians who created the arts of new, bending them into new spells. The 2 suns burned with a dual light, one dark orange as molten gold, the other, so soft blue as clear as the ocean. But this experience was not eternal. Darkness had once claimed the land.

* The Curtain is a thin, non-physical barrier the separates the realm of humans and demons.

*Arcane magic is an abbreviation of another magic arts.

*The 3 forbidden magic arts are: “Necromancy, Blooding and Clockveil”. About them are very little known. Only that each have an own Relic connected to it to activate the art.

The Story of Azuræ

Among men, the royal family of Von Astrea bore a sacred ritual. Their blood carried the Divine Protection, a magic older than all others, the creator and safeguard of The Curtain. And in this holder of time was born Prince Taro Von Astrea, whose heart was light with potential, yet heavy with negligence. For though he bore the power of the Divine Protection, he did not master it. He dallied, and in his dalliance, the balance of The Curtain began to weaken.

Then came the day the suns of Astrea vanished. One by one, their bright light dimmed, and the world fell into shadows. From the darkness emerged the demons, and the realms of man and woman merged within. The Curtain shattered, and the kingdom of Azurae fell into ruin. Its people became the mortal servants of the demons will.

By chance, or perhaps fate, Taro escaped the grasp from high. He fled north, into the frozen peaks of Rondo, fourteen mountains where frost and storm reign eternal. There, the temperatures reach under and beyond. And creatures of myth prowled unseen. For days he wandered, until the cold became a weight upon his frail body, and his strength failed him.

Yet when he opened his eyes, he found warmth. A fire burned before him, and his body bore no scar of the frost. He saw a river running clear and cold, and beside it lay his royal robes, in its beauty as the day he was crowned. In the quite yet calm campsite, a voice rang out, sharp with mockery:

"Did you sleep well?"

He turned to see a man, who offered provisions with a casual grace. *"I am Ryo,"* he said. *"And you?"* Taro gave his name, while confused and blurry, he had a lot of questions. He tended to Taro's needs with, and soon they spoke as comrades, though Taro could not shake the wonder of his own existence.

Days passed. Taro, recalling the ruin of his kingdom, felt the full weight of his negligence. He vowed to restore Azurae and free its people. Yet another question burned within him: How had he survived the merciless mountains unshattered? And who truly was Ryo?

At last, Ryo spoke of himself. He told of a kingdom long past, a thousand years before Taro's time, where he had wandered the great forests of Azurae. He had trained with a spirit of a Royal Protector long dead, learning the knowledge of arcane magic. His form, A flowing essence of ice. He had mastered what others could not: the forbidden art of Clockveil, and with its relic, the Staff of Time, he could slow, stop, or even rewind the threads of destiny. It was by this power he had spared Taro from death's will. Yet the magic bore a curse: eternal youth, a gift that had become a curse.

Ryo had fled Azurae to dwell beyond the Rondo peaks, guarding the fallen kingdom from the shadow from beasts and creatures beyond imagination. While yearning for the peace of mortal age, he thought it was a peace he would never taste.

Taro's eyes met Ryo's. *"Do you remember when I told you I am the holder of the Divine Protection some days back?"*

Ryo nodded, wary yet with intent.

"Divine Protection," Taro continued, *"in its highest potential, it can remove magic itself. If you aid me in restoring The Curtain, I will learn to free you from your eternal youth."*

A silence fell, as if the mountains themselves held their breath.

"That is a promise?" Ryo asked, with sheer discomfort and relief.

"It is, I promise" Taro said.